

Apart from the benchmark scores, I also found the Vivo V29e slightly underpowered while using the smartphone for high performance tasks. While playing games for prolonged sessions, for example, I experience frame drops quite a few times. The smartphone also heated up quite a bit while gaming or using the camera. Further, the software, as usual, did not make the experience any better. The Vivo FunTouch OS as usual, has a bunch of bloatware and

juice for the smartphone to last more than 1.5 days easily, even with heavy usage.

I tested the battery quite extensively. The smartphone only lost 4 percent of its battery while playing Call of Duty Mobile on the highest-possible settings for 15 minutes. In one hour of GPS navigation, the Vivo V29e lost only 6 percent battery, which is great. In our video loop test, the smartphone lasted a brilliant 1220 minutes which is more than 20 hours!



AGENT 001's thoughts

"A high-performer it is, but in what department? In all the testing numbers I only saw it score high on a few metrics, which are cameras, design, display, and battery. If you care a bit about the performance as we know it, stay away, I'd say."

there are a bit too many permissions and pop-ups while doing just about anything for the first time on the Vivo V29e. Although the bloatware apps can be disabled, it isn't something every user will do. Furthermore, we have been told that there is a set of audience that actually prefers pre-loaded apps on their smartphones.

So yes, the performance is underwhelming. A Snapdragon 695 on a ₹27,000 smartphone just doesn't make sense, but there is more to the Vivo V29e that will appeal to its user base. Let's take a look at how the battery and camera performance on the new Vivo is.

BATTERY

Now, while the performance may not be up to the mark, but the battery backup on the Vivo V29e is brilliant. The smartphone comes with a 5,000mAh battery with support for 44W fast charging. The 5,000mAh battery unit gives the Vivo V29e enough

That is brilliant battery life. The 44W fast charger, on the other hand, feels slightly slow as it took about an hour to charge from 0-100 percent.

CAMERA

Coming to camera performance, this is an area where Vivo has established itself as one of the best in the game. The Vivo V29e aims to take that forward and offer a brilliant camera experience in the sub-Rs 30,000 segment. Now, has the smartphone been able to achieve that? I'm not very sure. We get a dual rear camera setup with a 64-megapixel primary shooter, and an 8-megapixel wide-angle lens.

The images out of this dual camera setup are good. Almost always, we get a sharp and detailed image on the smartphone, which is good in dynamic range. However, the images lack a certain vibrancy that people look for in smartphone photos.

The portraits on the Vivo V29e are very good. This is where we see Vivo's expertise in the camera department come forth. The details on the subject remain intact, with brilliant edge detection and very good background blur. Good stuff.

In low light, the camera struggles at times and the images lack details or are hazy in certain scenarios. Around the lights also, we see some halo effect, but that is not the case all the time.

VERDICT

So the Vivo V29e, in a nutshell, is overpriced. But only if you look at it from the performance angle. Otherwise, it comes with Vivo's premium design language with the curved glass and everything, and we get a very good camera setup with great battery and an accurate display. However, the underwhelming performance makes it difficult to recommend the Vivo V29e in a heartbeat since offering a Snapdragon 695 will limit the experience in the longer run, even for those who aren't looking for a powerful performance-centric device.

Yes, we may not get as premium a design as this, but there are smartphones that offer a good enough camera along with brilliant performance and a better display in this range. So yeah, the Vivo V29e isn't the best phone for this budget in terms of the hardware used, but if you don't care much for performance and want something that looks good and has a brilliant battery and design, along with a very good camera, you can take a look at the Vivo V29e.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Body Dimensions: 16.442cm (164.42 mm) × 7.492cm (74.92 mm) × 0.757cm (7.57 mm)
 | Weight: 180.5g | Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 695 | RAM & ROM: 8 GB + 128 GB | 8 GB + 256 GB | Battery: 5000 mAh | Operating System: Funtouch OS 13 Global | Screen: 17.22cm (6.78-inch) | Resolution: 2400 × 1080 (FHD+) | Type: AMOLED | Card Slot: 1 nano SIM + 1 nano SIM / 1 microSD | Camera: Front 50 MP AF / Rear 64 MP OIS + 8 MP wide-angle

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